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ASH PONDRS/NEW YORK TIMES

A crowd packed the public service memorial Sunday for Charlie Kirk at State Farm Stadium in Glendale, Ariz.

‘A martyr now for American freedom’

Memorial for Kirk a massive mix of religious zeal, politicking, and talk of dark forces behind death

By Jack Healy, Tyler Pager, and Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs
NEW YORK TIMES

GLENDALÉ, Ariz. — Part Christian prayer service, part supersize political rally, the memorial on Sunday for slain conservative king-maker Charlie Kirk drew tens of thousands of supporters to fill a football stadium and cheer speech after speech calling him a martyr and praising the tireless missionary to America’s right-leaning youth.

“Our greatest evangelist for American liberty became immortal,” President Trump said. “He’s a martyr now for American freedom.”

But before long the president shifted to attacks on “radical left lunatics” and the un-

named groups that he said had cheered Kirk’s death.

“Some of the same people who call you a hater for using the wrong pronoun were filled with glee at the killing of a father with two beautiful young children,” Trump said.

“No side in American politics has a monopoly on disturbed or misguided people,” he went on, “but there’s one part of our political community which believes they have a monopoly on truth, goodness, and virtue, and concludes they have also a monopoly on power of thought or speech.

“Well, that’s not happening anymore; we’ve turned that corner quite quickly,” Trump said.

The more than five-hour tableau was a re-

markable fusion of God and country, church and state.

Vice President JD Vance, whose Catholic faith has been central to his own political rise and mission, praised his friend’s openness about his religious beliefs.

“We must remember that he is a hero to the United States of America. And he is a martyr for the Christian faith,” he said.

But he and others spoke of dark forces behind Kirk’s slaying, rather than a single gunman.

“They tried to silence our dear friend Charlie Kirk, but today and tonight we speak for Charlie louder than ever,” he said, adding later: “He was taken from us by those who despise the virtues that actually make our civilization great to begin with.”

In contrast, Kirk’s widow, Erika Kirk, spoke of the man accused of killing her husband.

KIRK, Page A7

A growing push to recognize Palestine

Major US allies announce shift ahead of UN meeting; Netanyahu blasts effort

By Steve Hendrix
WASHINGTON POST

LONDON — Britain, Canada, and Australia formally recognized a state of Palestine on Sunday, reversing decades of unwillingness to accept Palestinians as a sovereign nation until their conflict with Israel was permanently settled and breaking sharply with the United States.

The three nations became the biggest countries to recognize a Palestinian state, acting in coordination with France, which is expected to make a similar declaration on Monday at the United Nations. Later Sunday, Portuguese Foreign Minister Paulo Rangel announced from the UN that his country was also formally recognizing a Palestinian state.

Their embrace of Palestinian statehood is a momentous shift in long-standing diplomatic positions and reflects the grave consternation in many capitals over Israel’s war in Gaza.

Britain, Canada, and France, the first members of the Group of Seven major economies to take such a step, are some of the biggest traditional Israel supporters — and U.S. allies — to recognize a Palestinian state. Canadian Prime Minister Mark

PALESTINE, Page A4

Protesters face new realities on campuses

Pro-Palestinian groups exhausted but resolute

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Pro-Palestinian protesters commanded the spotlight on college campuses for nearly two years, holding rally after rally, building encampments, signing petitions, and occupying buildings as they raised awareness about the Israel-Hamas war and growing death toll in Gaza.

They got the attention they sought — but at a cost. Protesters at New England colleges have scored limited concrete wins in pushing their universities to cut ties with Israel as some tactics have provoked a blistering backlash to their movement.

Students this fall return to an increasingly hostile landscape: Colleges have amped up discipline for protests they’ve claimed are antisemitic, while President Trump has centered the movement’s excesses in efforts to reshape higher education.

Now, as the Gaza war approaches its third year, organizers say some who rallied their campuses to support Palestinians are fatigued by the bloody conflict. Others sympathetic to the cause are wary

PROTESTERS, Page A4

Attention Boston area police — ICE wants you

Agency ad urges officers to quit, join growing ranks of immigration agents

By Shelley Murphy
GLOBE STAFF

Television ads urging Boston area police officers to leave their departments and join the Trump administration’s crackdown on illegal immigration began airing on Boston stations last week.

“Attention Boston law enforcement,” an announcer says in the spot sponsored by US Immigration and Customs Enforcement. “You took an oath to protect & serve, to keep your family, your city safe. But in sanctuary cities, you’re ordered to stand down while dangerous illegals walk free.”

The ad, which flashes images of ICE agents leading people away in handcuffs, urges officers to join ICE, to help “catch the worst of the worst, drug traffickers, gang members, predators” and offers a hefty incentive: a \$50,000 sign-up bonus, student loan forgiveness, and “generous benefits.”

Similar ads have been aired over the past several weeks in other Democrat-led cities, including Chicago, New York, Los Angeles, and New Orleans. They’re part of a sweeping recruitment campaign launched by ICE in July after Trump signed a bill earmarking \$30 billion more to the



BLOOMBERG NEWS FILE

The US Immigration and Customs Enforcement is on a hiring blitz.

agency for recruitment and hiring. Department of Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem announced that ICE has already received more

than 150,000 applications and extended more than 18,000 tentative job offers.

ICE AD, Page A10

Terror, chaos in country club

Ex-employee faces murder charge in death of N.H. diner

By Sarah Rahal and Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

NASHUA — Evie O’Rourke was sitting in her Salem living room Saturday night when breaking news flashed across her television: a shooting at the Sky Meadow Country Club in Nashua, the community where her son had just moved. Heart pounding, she dialed his number.

“When I called, I got his wife, and she was hysterical,” O’Rourke said in a phone interview with the Globe. “She was rushed out, and everything went into lockdown.”

Authorities said a former employee opened fire inside the private club’s steakhouse Saturday night, killing O’Rourke’s son, 59-year-old Robert Steven DeCesare, and wounding two others before being arrested.

New Hampshire Attorney General



Robert Steven DeCesare was slain Saturday in Nashua.

ing “Free Palestine” — before opening fire, but said there is currently no evidence his remarks were connected to his motive.

“At this point, the evidence leads us to believe that it is more likely that Mr. Nadeau was simply trying to make a number of statements to create chaos in the moment,” Formella said at a press conference Sunday. “We don’t have any evidence to indicate that this was a hate-based act.”

Officials said there is no known connection between Nadeau and DeCesare.

NASHUA, Page A10

A FOOTBALL LOOSE KIND OF DAY



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

New England Patriots running back Rhamondre Stevenson fumbled the ball in the first quarter at Gillette Stadium Sunday. It was one of five Patriots turnovers in a 21-14 loss to the Pittsburgh Steelers. C1.

Carbuyers are rushing to purchase electric vehicles before tax breaks expire at the end of the month. D1.

Election workers completed a recount in Boston, affirming the District 7 winners of the preliminary vote. B1.

Clear the ray for

Monday: Lots of sun. High 69-74, low 58-63.
Tuesday: Afternoon shower. High 81-86, low 62-67.
Sunrise: 6:32. Sunset: 6:41.
Weather and comics, D4-5.
Obituaries, B6.

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